


intense off-roading in Mumbai, the unmistakable grab handle on the passenger side does it give it a nice adventurous touch. The quilted leather seats with the AMG badging lend a premium look, while the black, grey and silver chrome accents through the car are definitely easy on my eye. I have always been a fan of Mercedes's aviation-turbine-style AC vents and the G 63 places two of them right at the centre console, framed elegantly in a metallic box, with a variety of hard keys (full marks for these) and sitting atop another line of hard keys that control the AC functions.

The G 63 gets the AMG-style steering wheel, which looks very luxe by the way, and I do spend a lot of time turning the rotary dials to select different functions and watch the corresponding animations on the driver display. My favourite interior feature on all recent Mercedes cars is the dual touchscreens that sweep across the front of the cabin. In this car, there are two 12.3 inch touchscreens. The driver display is beautifully designed, highlight customisable and integrates augmented reality into the navigation aids quite effortlessly. The centre touchscreen features the manufacturer's MBUX infotainment system, which works without a glitch when connected to my iPhone with CarPlay. The infotainment suite comes packed with 18 speakers by Burmester.

Other cabin features that I do appreciate are the panoramic sunroof—it makes Mumbai look so much nicer when driving through the city, with a cabin bathed in natural light—and the three-zone AC system, which functions without any glitches.

Despite no high-speed stretches, I do spend a lot of time tinkering with the cars many safety features. The G 63 comes packed, as you would expect, with a series of advanced driver assist systems. Active brake assist, lane keep assist, blind spot assist and a 360-degree camera, which are always welcome in both city and countryside driving conditions.

The overall drive quality is impressive and given the engine capability, only one tap of the accelerator on relatively empty freeway stretches sends the car rocketing forward, with that extremely satisfying, throaty groan, enhanced further when switched into sports mode.

Let's face it; nothing marries cult status with performance, like this sporty and rugged beast. With pure luxury on the inside, and packed with tech and design accents, this one defines desire.

**MERCEDES-AMG G 63**

**Power** 577 hp
**Torque** 850 NM
**Acceleration** 0-100 kmph: 4.5 seconds
**Engine type** 4.0 Litre V8
**Top speed** 220 kmph
**Transmission** Automatic 9-gears, manual override/ paddle shift
**Price** ₹3.6 crore ++